

# Yong Ma

✉ yong.ma@uib.no

🐦 @yomar20190211

🌐 <https://www.linkedin.com/in/yong-ma-907a61185/>

☎ +49-15207660245



## Education

- 10.2017 – 11.2022 **Ph.D., Medieninformatik, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München (LMU Munich), Munich, Germany**  
Thesis title: *Emotion-Aware Voice Interface Based on Speech Signal Processing*
- 09.2014 – 06.2017 **M.Sc., Electrical and Electronic Engineering, University of Electronic Science and Technology of China (UESTC), Chengdu, China**  
Thesis title: *Wearable Social Perception System Based on Unsupervised Speaker Segmentation.*
- 09.2009 – 06.2013 **B.S., Electrical Engineering and Automation, Hubei Normal University(HNB), Huangshi, China**  
Thesis title: *Control System of Steam Drum Water Level for Boilers Design and Simulation.*

## Work and Academic Experience

- 07.2026– Present **Postdoctoral Researcher, KTH Royal Institute of Technology, Division of Robotics, Perception and Learning (RPL), Stockholm, Sweden.** *Brain-Robot Interfaces, Multimodal Human-Robot Interaction, and Intelligent Voice Interfaces* (Prof. Danica Kragic Jensfelt and Prof. Mårten Björkman)
- 04.2023 – 05.2026 **Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Bergen, Department of Information Science and Media Studies, Speech Signal Processing and Emotion-Aware Voice Interfaces: Applications in Dementia Care and Elderly Healthcare** (Prof. Morten Fjeld)
- 02.2026 – 07.2026 **Visiting Researcher, Technical University of Munich, Chair of Health Informatics (CHI), Speech Emotion Detection and its Application in Emotion-Aware Voice Interface Design** (Prof. Björn Schuller)
- 10.2019 – 03.2020 **Internship, Huawei Technologies Duesseldorf GmbH, Speech Emotion Recognition and Speech Synthesis in HCI**

## Research Project

- 12 2014 - 12 2015 **Wearable Autism Voice Monitoring System**  
Project Introduction: *The research was about a wearable autism voice monitoring system. This system can be utilised to assess infantile autism through the use of wearable devices that can record people's voice and analyze speech features such as fundamental speech features, rhythm speech features, and social perceptual speech features. These characteristics can assist to detect stress in persons with autistic disorder.*
- 01 2015 - 10 2016 **Wearable Autism Behavior Monitoring System**  
Project Introduction: *The research mainly focused on a wearable autism behavior monitoring system. On the basis of the behavioral difference between the people with infantile autism and the general population, this system can be used to analyze the mental stress in persons with autism through the analysis of speech features and motion behavioral features..*

## Research Publications

- 1 Ma, Y., Zhang, Y., Fu, D., Zubicueta Portales, S., & Fjeld, M. (2026, March). Neutral by default? replicating user vocal responses to negative affective cues in conversational agents. In *Proceedings of the 21st acm/ieee international conference on human-robot interaction (hri '26)* (pp. 1–5). Edinburgh, Scotland, UK: ACM.
- 2 Zhang, X., Ye, Y., Ma, Y., Zhang, Z. T., & Butz, A. (2026, March). Beyond information amount: Rethinking transparency through active reasoning demand. In *Proceedings of the 21st acm/ieee international conference on human-robot interaction (hri '26)* (pp. 1–10). Edinburgh, Scotland, UK: ACM.
- 3 Dai, D., Zhang, Y., Ma, Y., & Kragic, D. (2026). Ai that moves with you: A review of interactive technologies powered by large foundation models for mobility impairment. In *Proceedings of the 2026 chi conference on human factors in computing systems (chi '26)* (pp. 1–23). New York, NY, USA: Association for Computing Machinery.
- 4 Fu, D., Zhang, Y., Ma, Y., Kyrarini, M., Chen, C., Jirak, D., ... Kragic, D. (2026). Interai: Interactive ai for human-centered robotics. In *Companion proceedings of the 21st acm/ieee international conference on human-robot interaction* (pp. 1408–1410).
- 5 Ma, Y., Zhang, X., Zhang, X., Bartłomiejczyk, N., Je, S., Holzer, A., ... Butz, A. (2026). Beyond words: Measuring user experience through speech analysis in voice user interfaces. In *Proceedings of the 2026 chi conference on human factors in computing systems (chi '26)* (pp. 1–25). New York, NY, USA: Association for Computing Machinery.
- 6 Ma, Y., Zhang, Y., Andrews, P., Wu, Z., Portales, S. Z., & Fjeld, M. (2026). “Same Voice, Different Language”: An Exploration of Voice-Cloned Translation to Support Non-Native Speakers in Online Meetings. In *Proceedings of the 31st international conference on intelligent user interfaces (iui '26)* (pp. 1–17). Paphos, Cyprus: Association for Computing Machinery.
- 7 Zhang, Y., Fu, D., Ma, Y., Yadollahi, E., Leite, I., & Kragic, D. (2026). The 3rd interai workshop: Interactive ai for human-centered robotics. In *Proceedings of the extended abstracts of the 2026 chi conference on human factors in computing systems* (pp. 1–8).
- 8 Zhang, Y., Ma, Y., Fu, D., Zubicueta Portales, S., Fjeld, M., & Kragic, D. (2026). Personalizing emotion-aware conversational agents? exploring user traits-driven conversational strategies for enhanced interaction. *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*, 1–38.
- 9 Ma, Y., Zhang, X., Zhang, Y., & Fjeld, M. (2025). Measuring user experience through speech analysis: Insights from hci interviews. In *Extended abstracts of the 2025 chi conference on human factors in computing systems* (pp. 1–4).
- 10 Ma, Y., Zhang, Y., Fu, D., Portales, S. Z., Kragic, D., & Fjeld, M. (2025). Advancing user-voice interaction: Exploring emotion-aware voice assistants through a role-swapping approach. In *International conference on human-computer interaction* (pp. 240–255). Springer.
- 11 Ma, Y., Zhang, Y., Nordberg, O. E., Rongve, A., Bachinski, M., & Fjeld, M. (2025). State-of-the-art hci for dementia care: A scoping review of recent technological advances. *Journal of Dementia and Alzheimer's Disease*, 2(4), 41.
- 12 Zhang, Y., Ma, Y., Di, F., Portales, S. Z., Fjeld, M., & Kragic, D. (2025). Navigating users in emotion-aware conversational agents: Exploring strategies for enhanced interaction. *Available at SSRN 5148530*.
- 13 Ma, Y., Nordberg, O. E., Hubbers, J., Zhang, Y., Rongve, A., Bachinski, M., & Fjeld, M. (2024). Bridging the gap: Advancements in technology to support dementia care—a scoping review. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2404.09685*.
- 14 Ma, Y., Nordberg, O. E., Zhang, Y., Rongve, A., Bachinski, M., & Fjeld, M. (2024). Understanding dementia speech: Towards an adaptive voice assistant for enhanced communication. In *Companion proceedings of the 16th acm sigchi symposium on engineering interactive computing systems* (pp. 15–21).

- 15 Ma, Y., Zhang, Y., Fu, D., Jahanshahikhabisi, M., Matviienko, A., Bachinski, M., ... Kragic, D. (2024). Haid: Human-ai interaction for dementia care. In *Adjunct proceedings of the 2024 nordic conference on human-computer interaction* (pp. 1–4).
- 16 Zhang, Y., Kassem, K., Gong, Z., Mo, F., Ma, Y., Kirjavainen, E., & Häkkinen, J. (2024). Human-centered ai technologies in human-robot interaction for social settings. In *Proceedings of the international conference on mobile and ubiquitous multimedia* (pp. 501–505).
- 17 Zhang, Y., Ma, Y., & Kragic, D. (2024). Vision beyond boundaries: An initial design space of domain-specific large vision models in human-robot interaction. In *Adjunct proceedings of the 26th international conference on mobile human-computer interaction* (pp. 1–8).
- 18 Zhang, Y., Rajabi, N., Taleb, F., Matviienko, A., Ma, Y., Björkman, M., & Kragic, D. (2024). Mind meets robots: A review of eeg-based brain-robot interaction systems. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2403.06186*.
- 19 Zhang, Y., Yadollahi, E., Ma, Y., Fu, D., Leite, I., & Kragic, D. (2024). The 1st interai workshop: Interactive ai for human-centered robotics. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2409.11150*.
- 20 Ma, Y., Zhang, Y., Bachinski, M., & Fjeld, M. (2023). Emotion-aware voice assistants: Design, implementation, and preliminary insights. In *Proceedings of the eleventh international symposium of chinese chi* (pp. 527–532).
- 21 Ma, Y., Drewes, H., & Butz, A. (2022). How should voice assistants deal with users' emotions? *arXiv preprint arXiv:2204.02212*.
- 22 Ma, Y., Yomna, A., Petz, B., Drewes, H., Alt, F., Hussmann, H., & Andreas, B. (2022). Enthusiasts, pragmatists, and skeptics: Investigating users' attitudes towards emotion- and personality-aware voice assistants across cultures. In *Mensch und computer 2022* (pp. 1–15).
- 23 Li, J., Ma, Y., Li, P., & Butz, A. (2021). A journey through nature: Exploring virtual restorative environments as a means to relax in confined spaces. In *Creativity and cognition* (pp. 1–9).
- 24 Ma, Y., Drewes, H., & Butz, A. (2021). Fake moods: Can users trick an emotion-aware voicebot? In *Extended abstracts of the 2021 chi conference on human factors in computing systems* (pp. 1–4).
- 25 Ma, Y., Li, J., Drewes, H., & Butz, A. (2021). You sound relaxed now—measuring restorative effects from speech signals. In *Ifip conference on human-computer interaction* (pp. 585–594). Springer.
- 26 Zhang, Y., Ma, Y., Adel, O., Yadav, R., Fjeld, M., & Fratarcangeli, M. (2020). Automated microwave tomography (mwt) image segmentation: State-of-the-art implementation and evaluation.
- 27 Zhang, Y., Ma, Y., Omrani, A., Yadav, R., Fjeld, M., & Fratarcangeli, M. (2019). Automatic image segmentation for microwave tomography (mwt) from implementation to comparative evaluation. In *Proceedings of the 12th international symposium on visual information communication and interaction* (pp. 1–2).
- 28 Gu, J., Gao, B., Chen, Y., Jiang, L., Gao, Z., Ma, X., ... Woo, W. L. (2017). Wearable social sensing and its application in anxiety assesment. In *2017 international conference on cyber-enabled distributed computing and knowledge discovery (cyberc)* (pp. 305–308). IEEE.
- 29 Gu, J., Gao, B., Chen, Y., Jiang, L., Gao, Z., Ma, X., ... Jin, J. (2017). Wearable social sensing: Content-based processing methodology and implementation. *IEEE Sensors Journal*, 17(21), 7167–7176.
- 30 Sun, Y. X., Hu, J. P., Shi, K. B., Ma, Y., Zhao, Y. Y., & Zhang, Y. P. (2017). Reduced-order observer-based consensus for multi-agent systems with nonuniform time-varying delays. In *2017 chinese automation congress (cac)* (pp. 3052–3057). IEEE.
- 31 Sun, Y. X., Ma, Y., Shi, K. B., Hu, J. P., Zhao, Y. Y., & Zhang, Y. P. (2017). Unsupervised speaker segmentation framework based on sparse correlation feature. In *2017 chinese automation congress (cac)* (pp. 3058–3063). IEEE.

## Academic Service

---

- 2024  Mensch und Computer (MuC) Associate Chair (AC).
-  CSCW Associate Chair (AC)
-  Reviewer for CHI, Ro-Man, ICMI, HCII, TEI, and MuC conferences, Frontiers, etc.
- 2025  Mensch und Computer (MuC) Associate Chair (AC).
- 2026  Social Media Chair for ACM CUI 2026
-  ConfTool Chair for MuC2026 (Mensch und Computer 2026)

## Workshop Organization

- 2024  Co-Organizer of the RO-MAN 2024 Workshop: Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics
-  First Organizer of the NordiCHI 2024 Workshop: HAID: Human-AI Interaction for Dementia Care
-  Co-Organizer of the MuM 2024 Workshop: Human-Centered AI Technologies in Human-Robot Interaction for Social Settings
- 2026  Co-Organizer of the HRI 2026 Workshop: InterAI: Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics
-  Co-Organizer of the CHI 2026 Workshop: Workshop: The 3rd InterAI Workshop: Interactive AI for Human-centered Robotics

## Awards and Honors

---

- 2026  **Best Paper Award, CHI 2026**  
Awarded for the paper: *AI That Moves with You: A Review of Interactive Technologies Powered by Large Foundation Models for Mobility Impairment.*
-  **Honorable Mention Award, CHI 2026**  
Awarded for the paper: *Beyond Words: Measuring User Experience through Speech Analysis in Voice User Interfaces.*
-  **Best Paper, IUI 2026**  
Awarded for the paper: *"Same Voice, Different Language": An Exploration of Voice-Cloned Translation to Support Non-Native Speakers in Online Meetings.*

## Teaching and Supervising Experience

---

### Teaching Experience

- 2023  **Teaching Assistant**, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) course, University of Bergen.
- 2024  **Guest Lecturer**, Voice Interfaces course for Bachelor's program, University of Bergen.

### Supervising Experience

- 2018–2021  Supervised several Master's and Bachelor's thesis projects at LMU Munich.

## Skills

---

- Languages  English and Chinese.
- Coding  Python, Matlab, R, C, C++,  $\text{\LaTeX}$ , ...
- Web Dev  HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP.

## Interests

---

Jogging, Football and Table Tennis

## Interests (continued)

---

Reading and Classical Music

Hiking and Photography



# Best Paper Award

Presented to:

**Duosi Dai, Yuchong Zhang, Yong Ma,  
Danica Kragic**

For their contribution titled:

**AI That Moves With You: A Review of  
Interactive Technologies Powered by  
Large Foundation Models for Mobility  
Impairment**

A handwritten signature in black ink, likely belonging to David Shamma.

David Shamma, Nuria Oliver  
General Chairs

A handwritten signature in black ink, likely belonging to Cosmin Munteanu.

Cosmin Munteanu, Marianna Obrist,  
Albrecht Schmidt,

Award Chairs



Association for  
Computing Machinery





# Honorable Mention

Presented to:

**Yong Ma, Xuesong Zhang, Xuedong Zhang, Natalia  
Bartłomiejczyk, Seungwoo Je, Adrian Holzer, Morten Fjeld,  
Andreas Butz**

For their contribution titled:

**Beyond Words: Measuring User Experience  
through Speech Analysis in Voice User  
Interfaces**

David Shamma, Nuria Oliver  
General Chairs

Cosmin Munteanu, Marianna  
Obrist, Albrecht Schmidt,  
Award Chairs





# The Annual ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces

on July 13–16 2026 in Limassol, Cyprus

*is proud to present this*

## Best Paper Award

*to*

**Yong Ma, Yuchong Zhang, Peter Andrews, Zhikun Wu, Stephanie Zubicueta Portales,  
Morten Fjeld**

*for their paper titled:*

**“Same Voice, Different Language”: An Exploration of Voice-Cloned  
Translation to Support Non-Native Speakers in Online Meetings**

Li Chen

Program Co-Chair

Giulio Jacucci

Program Co-Chair

Alison Renner

Program Co-Chair

Styliani Kleanthous

General Co-Chair

Tsvi Kuflik

General Co-Chair

